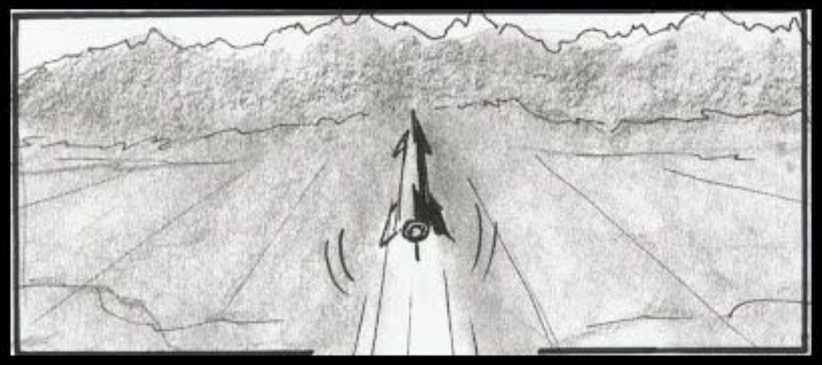
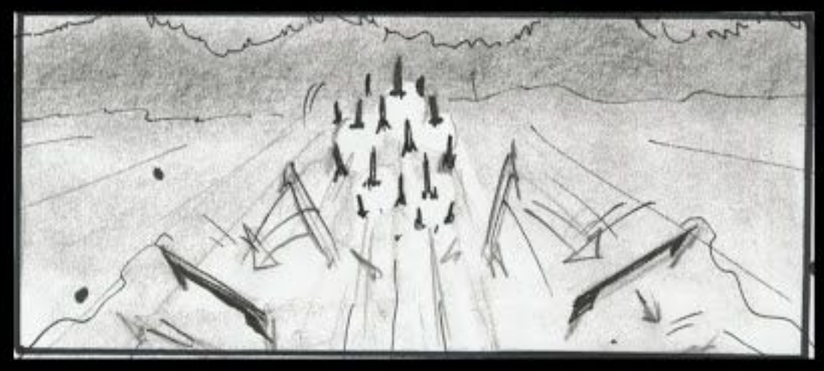
















For a film as heavily laden with gee-whiz action effects as *Iron Man*, the pre-production process is hugely important. Jon Favreau's two greatest assets during *Iron Man*'s pre-production were his storyboard and pre-visual effects teams. The latter group is responsible for what is known in the industry as "pre-vis," an elaborate undertaking wherein 2D and 3D concepts are adapted into often fully realized animations of the complex action beats of a film. As the expense budgets of films like *Iron Man* climb through the stratosphere, pre-vis gives the director and producer a chance to "practice" tough shots and gain confidence on their way to principal photography.



Above, right: Weapons test storyboards (Michael Jackson)